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jective is to make the internet more accessible—with Indian language access and affordable handsets. “We want to help more women come online and also ensure that the small and medium businesses (SMBs) gain from the internet,” he says. And on trust, he says Google understands that India’s digital transformation brings with it a lot of responsibility. “That means people want control over their data or want their kids to be safe online or just the safety of money while transacting online.”

A key moment in Google’s journey here took place around five to

“OUR CORE STRATEGY IS ABOUT TWO WORDS—INCLUSION AND TRUST. WE WANT TO MAKE THE INTERNET HELPFUL AND SAFE FOR A BILLION INDIANS”

SANJAY GUPTA

COUNTRY HEAD AND VICE PRESIDENT, GOOGLE INDIA

six years ago. “We noticed a big shift where more youth were coming online. Almost all of them were mobile-first and a large chunk was mobile-only. The way they used the internet was very different,” says Gupta. The primary drivers of adoption were video, voice and local languages. “The dynamics then were a giveaway on the next big use case for the internet evolving from India. In fact, we will see more innovations from here and other countries in Asia.” The groundwork for the ‘next billion users’ strategy took off there. “If we focus on solving the needs of people in these